

was amazing. More amazingly, both Joel and Alexis agreed that they didn't have to sacrifice anything of value to achieve FI.

Joel and Alexis are a typical example of how an awakening happens. However, for many people in the FI community, awareness alone can become the catalyst for change. This is a pattern that came up repeatedly in interviews with those who are FI or are on the path.

One great example of awareness leading to awakening is the story of Noah and Becky, young professionals living in Washington state who write the blog *Money Metagame*. They noted that they started their adult lives responsibly, simply checking "all the big boxes that adults do." House? Check. Cars? Check. Investing enough in their 401(k)s to get the employer match? Check.

They shared that they were saving "a solid 6 percent [of their income] in 2014." Becky was a young neonatal nurse, and she quickly started burning out under the demands of her job. Noah and Becky began looking for how they might change their lifestyle, and they discovered the concept of FI.

Within one year, their savings rate went from 6 percent to 58 percent. While the numbers are amazing, their analysis is even more incredible for a couple that made such seemingly drastic changes.